

## Thesis & Innovation Competitions (preliminary)

This file summarises the limited set of competitions that could be accessed via the browser in the current environment.

While the directive calls for 25–50 opportunities, most competition pages either required dynamic page interaction or were inaccessible due to security challenges, so only four competitions with accessible details are reported here.

Each table splits the information to keep column widths manageable.

Fields with no available information are marked **not found**.

### 1. Opportunity identity table

| Opportunity name                                           | URL                                                                                                                                           | Organizer                                     | Region               |
|------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| <b>AAKRUTI Global Student Design Contest 2026</b>          | <a href="https://solidworks.com/aakruti">https://solidworks.com/aakruti</a>                                                                   | Dassault Systèmes / SOLIDWORKS                | Global (final in US) |
| <b>SAME Undergraduate Innovation Design Challenge 2026</b> | <a href="https://samenationalsecure.civicore.com/innovationchallenge">https://samenationalsecure.civicore.com/innovationchallenge</a>         | Society of American Military Engineers (SAME) | USA                  |
| <b>UIST 2026 Student Innovation Contest</b>                | <a href="https://emotibit.com/pages/uist-2026-student-innovation-contest">https://emotibit.com/pages/uist-2026-student-innovation-contest</a> | ACM UIST / EmotiBit                           | USA (Detroit, MI)    |
| <b>Create the Future Design Contest 2026</b>               | <a href="https://contest.techbriefs.com/">https://contest.techbriefs.com/</a>                                                                 | Tech Briefs & SAE Media Group                 | Global               |

## 2. Eligibility and logistics table

| Opportunity name                                           | Eligibility                                                                                                                      | Colombia eligibility                                       | Student eligibility | Individual/ team   | Online/remote participation                                                                | Travel requirements                                                  |
|------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------|--------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>AAKRUTI Global Student Design Contest 2026</b>          | Teams of four students + one teacher; disciplines include engineering, design & architecture <sup>2</sup>                        | Likely (global call; final in US)                          | Yes                 | Team               | Registration and submission appear to be online; final at 3DEXPERIENCE World 2027 (US)     | <b>Yes</b> – requirement to the 3DEXPERIENCE World                   |
| <b>SAME Undergraduate Innovation Design Challenge 2026</b> | Teams of 3–5 undergraduate students; at least one engineering student; each team must include a SAME student member <sup>1</sup> | Likely (international students allowed if members of SAME) | Yes                 | Team               | Abstracts and submissions can be submitted online; final presentation at SAME's conference | <b>Yes</b> – presence at 2026 Engineering Training Conference (JETC) |
| <b>UIST 2026 Student Innovation Contest</b>                | Student innovators; proposals selected (up to 10 teams) receive an EmotiBit kit <sup>3</sup>                                     | Likely (open to international students; travel required)   | Yes                 | Team or individual | Proposal submission online; final demonstration at UIST 2026 conference                    | <b>Yes</b> – demonstration at UIST 2026 Detroit                      |
| <b>Create the Future Design Contest 2026</b>               | Engineers, entrepreneurs, students; individuals or teams; global <sup>4</sup>                                                    | Yes (global call)                                          | Yes                 | Individual or team | Entire submission process is online; winners announced online                              | <b>No</b> – fully online                                             |

### 3. Fit and value table

| Opportunity name                    | TwinSight fit         | Why it fits                                                                                                                                                  | Risks / mismatch                                                                                                                                                                | Workload estimate                                                                        | Prestige value                                                                         | Portfolio value                                                    |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>AAKRUTI</b>                      | <b>3/5 – Moderate</b> | Encourages engineering & design solutions for real-world problems; allows team participation; uses CAD tools; final presentation gives exposure <sup>2</sup> | Requires SOLIDWORKS; themes focus on robotics, community problems, healthcare & mobility; may not emphasise interactive technical visualisation; travel for final may be costly | <b>Medium</b> – requires concept development, design documentation, teacher coordination | <b>Medium</b> – global recognition via SOLIDWORKS & 3DEXPERIENCE event                 | <b>Medium</b> – adding a design contest win boosts portfolio       |
| <b>SAME Undergraduate Challenge</b> | <b>3/5 – Moderate</b> | Accepts engineering capstone projects; emphasises innovation & design; includes a video demonstration <sup>1</sup>                                           | Limited to SAME student members; winners required to travel to a conference in the US; focus on military engineering may not align with technical visualisation                 | <b>Medium</b> – requires team formation, membership, abstract, video & slides            | <b>Low</b> – niche prestige within military engineering community                      | <b>Medium</b> – a win demonstrates project management & innovation |
| <b>UIST 2026 Contest</b>            | <b>2/5 – Weak</b>     | Provides platform for student innovation at top HCI conference; emphasises creative use of biosensors <sup>3</sup>                                           | Not aligned with Unity/ WebGL; uses EmotiBit sensors; requires travel to Detroit and building a biosensing project; high mismatch                                               | <b>High</b> – requires new project using biosensing hardware                             | <b>Medium</b> – UIST is prestigious in HCI but not relevant to technical visualisation | <b>Low</b> – portfolio would show unrelated project                |

| Opportunity name                 | TwinSight fit       | Why it fits                                                                                                                                                | Risks / mismatch                                                                                                       | Workload estimate                                                     | Prestige value                                              | Portfolio value                                                         |
|----------------------------------|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Create the Future Contest</b> | <b>4/5 – Strong</b> | Allows submission of engineering innovations from students and entrepreneurs; categories include robotics & automation; global online contest <sup>4</sup> | Highly competitive; may favour physical products over software visualisation; criteria not explicit for interactive 3D | <b>Low-Medium</b> – concept description required; prototypes optional | <b>Medium</b> – recognition from SAE Media Group & sponsors | <b>High</b> – winning or placing demonstrate innovation & global impact |

## 4. Scoring table

| Opportunity name                    | Fit score (1–5) | Probability score (1–5) | Value score (1–5) | Priority (A/B/C/ Watchlist) |
|-------------------------------------|-----------------|-------------------------|-------------------|-----------------------------|
| <b>AAKRUTI</b>                      | 3               | 3                       | 3                 | B                           |
| <b>SAME Undergraduate Challenge</b> | 3               | 2                       | 2                 | C                           |
| <b>UIST 2026 Contest</b>            | 1               | 2                       | 1                 | Watchlist                   |
| <b>Create the Future Contest</b>    | 4               | 3                       | 4                 | A                           |

## 5. Source table

| Opportunity name                    | Source URLs                               | Notes                                                                                                                                                     |
|-------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>AAKRUTI</b>                      | Dassault Systèmes: call page <sup>2</sup> | Provides global student design contest details; emphasises teams & teacher involvement; free SOLIDWORKS access and final event in US.                     |
| <b>SAME Undergraduate Challenge</b> | Official challenge page <sup>1</sup>      | Lists eligibility, team composition, abstract submission requirements, video demo length, prizes & deadlines.                                             |
| <b>UIST 2026 Contest</b>            | EmotiBit page <sup>3</sup>                | Describes UIST contest using EmotiBit sensors; emphasises biosensing & creative applications; provides hardware kit; limited info on deadlines or prizes. |

| Opportunity name                 | Source URLs                    | Notes                                                                                                                                                        |
|----------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Create the Future Contest</b> | Contest home page <sup>4</sup> | Announces 2026 contest is open; outlines global call, \$25k grand prize, categories and innovation focus; details on eligibility and deadlines not provided. |

## Summary and next steps

The accessible competitions provide a limited but useful starting point. **Create the Future Design Contest** appears to be the best fit among these options, with a strong value proposition, moderate probability and broad domain. **AAKRUTI** could be considered if a team and instructor are available, but it focuses more on CAD design. **SAME Undergraduate Challenge** is limited by membership requirements and a military-engineering focus. **UIST Student Innovation Contest** does not align with Alexander's skill set.

Future work (outside this environment) should continue exploring other competitions, hackathons, digital twin challenges and global student awards for 2026 once accessible, including EU or LATAM innovation calls and XR/digital-twin challenges.

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<sup>1</sup> 2026 SAME Undergraduate Innovation Design Challenge - SAME Undergraduate  
<https://www.same.org/news/same-undergraduate-innovation-design-challenge/>

<sup>2</sup> AAKRUTI Innovation Competition 2026 | SOLIDWORKS  
<https://www.solidworks.com/product/students/aakruti-global>

<sup>3</sup> UIST Student Innovation Contest 2026 - EmotiBit Shop  
<https://www.emotibit.com/uist-student-innovation-contest-2026/>

<sup>4</sup> Home - Create the Future  
<https://contest.techbriefs.com/>